



Advertising

As well as promoting your business with marketing and PR activities, you can further increase your visibility by paying for advertising, using the medium best suited to your target audience.

Choosing your channel

Once you have launched your business with a promotion, paying for advertising can broaden your reach. In a competitive market, it is important to use

the right means of communication for your target audience. For instance, if your message is for an older demographic, traditional advertising in printed publications or on the radio can be more effective,

TRADITIONAL ADVERTISING		
	PROS	CONS
 DIRECT MAIL	› Reaches local/specific target market, such as restaurant diners › Delivered directly to people's homes/offices › Low cost	› May be regarded as junk mail and discarded › Typically low response rate
 NEWSPAPERS	› Fast publication process › Themed specialty sections may allow for targeted advertising › Can include coupons	› Offers no control over ad placement › Competition for attention with other material on page (including competitors) › Short shelf life and lower-quality printing
 MAGAZINES	› Is often in circulation for months › Specialty titles and themed sections allow focused adverts › Quality printing adds cachet to the brand	› Accurate circulation figures are hard to source › Advance planning is necessary to secure slots › Is more costly than newspapers since it reaches a more targeted demographic
 RADIO	› Inexpensive and easy production process › Useful for reaching a target audience › Good for creating immediate sales	› Listeners tend to "switch off" during adverts › Frequent adverts are required for an impact › Increased competition and higher cost for "rush hour" slots
 BILLBOARDS	› Highly visible, clear message, seen repeatedly at all times › Reaches people faster and more cheaply than other media	› Format limits message length › Competition for prime sites › Digital billboards are more effective, but much more expensive than static billboards
 CINEMA	› Potential to impress with creative, professional production › Captive audience › High impact	› Limited audience numbers › Audience may enter cinema only after adverts are shown
 TELEVISION	› Offers local, national, and global reach › High impact with vision/sound › Adds cachet to brand	› Generally more expensive than other channels › Repetition may cause viewer fatigue › Viewers may ignore or skip adverts on catch-up television/internet streaming